

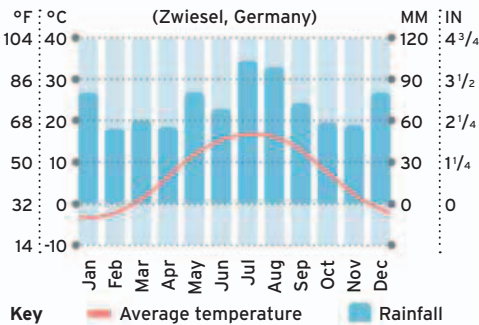
LOCATION

The Bavarian forest straddles the border between Germany and the Czech Republic, and becomes the Bohemian forest.



CLIMATE

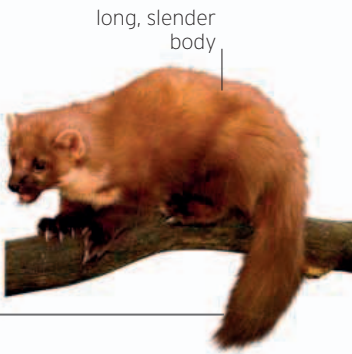
Rain falls as heavy snow during long, cold winters, and weather fronts from the Atlantic and Mediterranean mean constant rain year-round.



European pine marten

Martes martes

Pine martens can live in any tree-filled environment. Powerful forelimbs and strong claws allow them to leap from tree to tree in pursuit of small animals such as squirrels. Most of their hunting occurs on the ground, however, where they forage between dusk and dawn.



- 18-27 in (45-68 cm)
- 2-4 lb (0.8-1.8 kg)
- Common
- Small mammals, berries



Europe to N. and W. Asia



SNOW PATROL
In winter, pads on the marten's soles are covered with fur, which insulates its feet and provides traction in the snow.

European badger

Meles meles

Badgers live in groups of six or more members, sharing the same sett—a system of underground tunnels, chambers, and toilet areas. Setts may evolve into huge networks

over time. A sett is ruled by a dominant male, or boar, and one breeding female. The pair mate throughout the year, but a litter of one to five cubs is not born until February.

- 22-35 in (56-89 cm)
- 22-36 lb (10-16 kg)
- Common
- Earthworms, fruit, birds



Europe to W. Asia



WHITE-STRIPED IDENTITY

The badger's black-and-white striped face makes it instantly recognizable, but ginger-coated and albino (all-white) badgers have also been found.

short, powerful legs

MOSS SANCTUARY
Compared to flowering plants and ferns, the diversity of mosses in the national park is extraordinary. At around 490 species, this is 42 percent of mosses in Germany. They thrive because of the minimal human disturbance.

Species recorded here

Haircap moss